DAY 16 · THEORY HANDOUT

Give Each Message a Role

Separate steady rules, user requests, and earlier replies.

KGP Talkie

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The idea and its useful terms

Separate steady rules, user requests, and earlier replies.

System message

The app sets its job and steady rules here.

User message

The learner asks a question or supplies input here.

Assistant message

The model reply becomes part of the chat history.

A system message keeps a shared rule in one place. We do not need to copy it into every question.

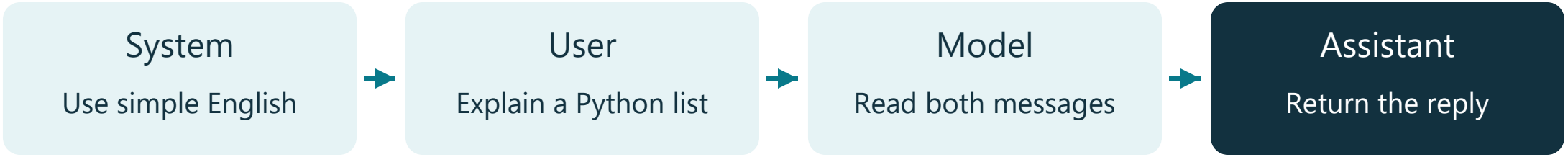
A role is a label attached to a message. A chat template turns role-labeled messages into the model input.

> The app must send the system message. A rule left out of the request cannot guide that request.

Follow the work, one step at a time

Each step has a job. We can inspect its output before moving on.

Read the path from left to right.



Each arrow means: pass the result to the next step.

The app sends a list of messages with role labels. The system message states the job. The user message supplies the question. Earlier assistant replies keep their own role when included as history.

The model receives the complete sent list as input. Different models apply their chat formats differently. A role instruction can guide a reply, but we still test whether the model follows it.

> If the answer is wrong, inspect the input and the intermediate results. The last sentence alone cannot show which step failed.

A small example we can check

The values here are classroom examples. The notebook shows actual results.

System	User	Assistant
You explain to beginners. Use two short sentences.	What is a variable? One question this turn.	A variable name points to a stored value.

Read the given input first. Point to the fact or value needed for the requested output.

Run the matching example, then try the fresh input at the end of the notebook. Compare both results with the known input.

> The app must send the system message. A rule left out of the request cannot guide that request.

Choose the setting or tool for its job

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A different choice changes the work. These are the choices we compare.

Steady rules

Put the job and style
in the system message.

Changing input

Put today's question
in the user message.

Earlier reply

Keep it as assistant text.
Do not call it a new fact.

Ask the same question with a beginner rule and then a technical rule.

Keep the user question unchanged so we can compare the role instruction.

> Check what happens when a user asks for a longer answer. A role label is not a guaranteed lock.

Practice, check, and read the full lesson

Use the notebook to try the steps. Use the article when you need the longer explanation.

1. Build

Run the small example.

Inspect each step.

2. Change

Try the fresh input.

Keep the goal clear.

3. Check

Compare with the source.

Keep mistakes visible.

Check what happens when a user asks for a longer answer. A role label is not a guaranteed lock.

Read the complete tutorial breakdown for this section in our KGP Talkie article.

> The app must send the system message. A rule left out of the request cannot guide that request.

DAY 16 · COMPLETE

Thank You

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